

Enterprise / Mayflower feasibility memo

Date: 2026-07-27

Executive take

The ****18-20 unit version is the safer base case**** and the ****22-unit version is the upside case****.

The main issue is ****not whether cottages can be sketched onto 5.03 acres****. The real issue is whether Enterprise will allow the product type and circulation pattern on this tract ****with only ~101 feet of Mayflower frontage and a diagonal creek/sewer corridor****.

The biggest entitlement warning I found: ****Enterprise's Cottage Development rule appears capped at 4 to 10 dwelling lots without street frontage****, even though it can be done as a subdivision, condominium, or combination. That means the current 18-22 unit concept set probably ****does not fit cleanly as a straight "cottage development" play****.

So the likely live paths are:

1. ****PRD / alternate planned residential path****, if the City will entertain a sub-10-acre tract, or
2. ****multifamily / condo-style development plan review****, depending on the parcel's current zoning and how staff classifies the product.

What we already know from the concept set

- Working parcel size: ****~5.03 acres****
- Working Mayflower frontage/access: ****~101 ft****
- The concept assumes ****single controlled access**** from Mayflower on the west/left side lower leg
- A ****NW→SE creek / sewer corridor**** cuts through the tract and is being treated as a real no-build/common-area spine
- Clint's updated 2026-07-27 plat markup now explicitly shows ****Mayflower on the entrance side****, plus the ****creek**** and ****sewer easement**** locations, which makes the single-entry / diagonal-corridor assumption materially more credible than before
- Existing concept files:
 - `enterprise-mayflower-concept-22-unit.svg`
 - `enterprise-mayflower-concept-18-20-unit.svg`
 - `enterprise-mayflower-corrected-concepts-v2.pdf`

What Enterprise code seems to say that matters most

1) Tiny homes on wheels are basically out for permanent occupancy
Enterprise zoning says only buildings meeting code and manufactured homes in the proper framework may be used for permanent residential occupancy; ****tiny homes on wheels are only permitted for temporary occupancy in RV parks/campgrounds****.

****Implication:**** if this is pursued, it should be framed as ****permanent cottages / cabins on foundations****, not THOWs.

2) The frontage likely supports only one meaningful entrance
Enterprise driveway spacing rules for "all other uses" on local streets show:

- ****75 ft**** minimum from an intersection
- ****50 ft**** minimum from other driveways
- ****1 driveway per 75 ft**** of frontage

With only about ****101 ft**** of frontage, the current ****single-entry concept**** looks directionally right.

****Implication:**** the site probably lives or dies on a clean single-entry internal drive layout.

3) Cottage Development is promising structurally, but the count cap is a real problem

Enterprise's Cottage Development section appears to allow cottage developments to be:

- subdivisions,
- condominium form, or
- a combination,

but also says they must contain **at least four dwellings but not more than ten dwelling lots that do not have street frontage**.

It also requires:

- **public water and sewer**
- **fire-access review** during plat review
- **250 sf minimum common open space per unit**
- cottages on **permanent foundations**, not portable units

Implication: if the City treats this tract as a Cottage Development, the present 18-22 unit scheme likely gets pushed down hard unless there is a different lotting/condo interpretation staff accepts.

4) Conservation Subdivision does not look like the right tool

Enterprise's Conservation Subdivision option appears limited to:

- **single-family detached residential**, and
- sites of at least **10 acres**

This tract is only ~5.03 acres.

Implication: I would not spend time trying to force this into the conservation-subdivision lane.

5) PRD may be the best entitlement angle if staff is flexible

Enterprise's PRD rules are intended to allow more flexible residential design and densities. The base rule appears to require **at least 10 acres**, but smaller sites **may be considered** where the acreage minimum is impractical and the design offers benefits that conventional zoning cannot reproduce.

That matters here because this site has:

- constrained frontage,
- a drainage/easement corridor,
- likely need for shared circulation/open space,
- a product concept that may fit better as a coordinated condo/planned residential project than fee-simple lots.

Implication: if we can tell a good story, PRD looks more plausible than trying to pretend this is a normal lot subdivision.

6) Multifamily review standards could also control this

Enterprise's code also indicates that **multifamily developments involving subdivision/resubdivision require Development Plan approval** so the layout of buildings, open spaces, circulation, drainage, and infrastructure can be reviewed against subdivision-like standards.

The multifamily standards snippet also indicates:

- building arrangement must suit topography and avoid excessive grading,
- building spacing must meet a formula with a **20 ft absolute minimum** and a larger typical target,
- multifamily buildings cannot be ringed entirely by parking/driveways,
- at least one side of each multifamily building needs meaningful open space / separation.

****Implication:**** if this goes condo/multifamily instead of cottage-lot subdivision, the internal layout still has to stay fairly disciplined. The open-space spine in the concepts is helping, not hurting.

7) Parking can quietly kill the high-count version
Enterprise parking standards for multifamily appear to be:

- ****1 space per studio or 1-BR****
- ****1.5 spaces per 2-BR****
- ****2 spaces per 3+ BR****
- plus ****2 visitor spaces per 10 dwelling units****

Very rough examples:

- ****18 one-bedroom units**** → about ****22 spaces****
- ****20 one-bedroom units**** → about ****24 spaces****
- ****22 one-bedroom units**** → about ****27 spaces****
- any meaningful 2-BR mix pushes that higher

****Implication:**** the 22-unit scheme is probably only worth defending if the unit mix stays compact and the parking/circulation layout remains clean under fire review.

What looks dead, weak, or risky

Weak / likely dead

- ****THOW / RV-style permanent community framing****
- ****Conservation subdivision path****
- ****Standard fee-simple subdivision assumptions without a custom entitlement story****

Live but risky

- ****22-unit plan**** if parking, fire turnaround, or drainage gets tight
- ****Cottage-development label**** if staff interprets the 10-lot cap strictly

Most credible right now

- ****18-20 permanent cottage / cabin units on foundations****
- owned through ****horizontal condo / site-condo / planned residential structure****
- with the corridor sold as a real shared amenity / stormwater / buffer spine

Best current recommendation

Base case to underwrite first
Underwrite ****18 units first****.

Why:

- gives more room for parking and emergency access,
- reduces the chance the corridor becomes an engineering problem,
- fits the premium/smaller-campus feel better,
- gives staff fewer reasons to say no.

Upside case

Keep ****20 units**** as a stretch target and ****22 only as an upside sketch****, not the headline count.

If this deal only works financially at 22+, that's a warning sign right now.

The real kill-tests

Before spending design money, these are the questions that matter most:

1. ****What is the parcel's current zoning?****

- Without that, we do not know whether the tract is already in a district that can support multifamily/condo style review or whether rezoning/PRD is mandatory

y.

2. ****Will Enterprise staff treat this as cottage development, multifamily condo, PRD, or something else?****
 - This is probably the biggest threshold question.
3. ****Will staff entertain a PRD on a 5.03-acre tract?****
 - The ordinance suggests smaller-than-10-acre PRDs can be considered, but not automatically.
4. ****Can fire access work with one entrance?****
 - The layout needs a real answer on lane width, turnarounds, hydrants, and building reach.
5. ****What is the exact geometry of the creek/sewer corridor?****
 - Survey and utility data may shrink the usable envelope more than the concept sketches assume.
6. ****Can parking be solved without the site feeling like a parking lot?****
 - This will probably decide whether 18/20/22 is real.
7. ****What floodplain / drainage restrictions exist beyond the visible corridor?***
 - If there is floodplain overlap, usable yield can drop fast.

What I'd do next

Immediate next step

Build a ****city/staff question sheet + pre-application call script**** and treat that as the gating move before deeper design.

Specific asks for Enterprise staff

1. What is the parcel's current zoning classification?
2. For this tract and product type, would staff steer us toward:
 - cottage development,
 - multifamily,
 - PRD,
 - condominium/site-condo,
 - or another path?
3. Does the cottage-development 10-lot rule effectively cap this concept well below 18 units?
4. Would the City consider a ****sub-10-acre PRD**** here based on site constraints and shared open space design?
5. Would a one-entry internal private-street/common-drive layout be acceptable in principle, subject to fire review?
6. What parking, fire-lane, hydrant, and turnaround expectations would control this site?
7. Are there known floodplain/drainage/utility constraints beyond the sewer-creek corridor already assumed?
8. Would staff want a Development Plan first, a rezoning/PRD request first, or a preliminary plat first?

Source links used for this pass

- Engineering / document center: <https://www.enterpriseal.gov/services/engineering/index.php>
- Zoning ordinance mirror: <https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL>
- Article 3 general regulations: https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_3
- Article 6 special districts / PRD: https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_6
- Article 7 use-specific regs: https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_7

- Article 8 parking/loading: [https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_8`](https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_8)
- Article 13 administration / development-plan submittals: [https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_13`](https://www.zoneomics.com/code/enterprise-AL/chapter_13)

Bottom line

I would ****not**** market this to ourselves as a 22-unit sure thing.

I would treat it as:

- ****18 units likely defensible****,
- ****20 units possible if the geometry behaves****,
- ****22 units only if staff, parking, fire access, and drainage all cooperate****.

And the very next move should be a ****tight city-entitlement screen****, not prettier concept art.